

# The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Growth of Wisdom and Intelligence through the Noble Venerable Mañjuśrī'

Āryamañjuśrībhaṭṭāarakasya prajñābuddhivardhanā nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 549 · Derge Kangyur

རྣམ་པར་ཤེས་པ་འཇམ་དཔལ་གྱི་སེ་རབ་དང་བསྐྱེད་ལེ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུང་ས།

Toh 549 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryamañjuśrībhaṭṭāarakasya Prajñābuddhivardhanā Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the dhāraṇī of "The Growth of Wisdom and Intelligence through the Noble Venerable Mañjuśrī." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on a short but potent mantra invocation dedicated to Mañjuśrī, the bodhisattva of wisdom. The text promises a remarkable range of benefits to those who hold, carry, or recite the dhāraṇī, including the swift arising of intelligence and eloquence, the recall of past lives, great learning, and the accumulation of vast merit across countless eons. As a dhāraṇī scripture, it exemplifies the genre of compact ritual and contemplative texts that pair a sacred formula with descriptions of its spiritual efficacy.

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In the language of India: Āryamañjuśrībhaṭṭāarakasya prajñābuddhivardhanā nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Growth of Wisdom and Intelligence through the Noble Venerable Mañjuśrī."

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Namo Mañjuśrīye kumārāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ araje viraje śuddhe viśuddhe śodhanī viśodhanī śodhaya viśodhaya amale vimale jayavatī ruru cale hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī will, within a single month, come to possess intelligence. Their voice will become melodious. Their form will become beautiful. Whoever recites it once will, for the span of a thousand eons, turn their back on cyclic existence. Whoever merely carries it will remember their past lives. Whoever recites it one hundred thousand times will become learned. Whoever recites it two hundred thousand times will become a holder of knowledge. Whoever recites it three hundred thousand times will behold the face of Mañjuśrī. If one has committed the five acts of immediate retribution (the five heinous deeds with no interval before their karmic consequence) and yet fails to attain accomplishment through this practice, then at that time I

myself shall commit the five acts of immediate retribution, and I myself shall have deceived the blessed buddhas.

## Translator's Notes

- The phrase "the five acts of immediate retribution" renders ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, literally "the five without interval," the standard Tibetan for the Sanskrit ānantarya-karma: patricide, matricide, killing an arhat, wounding a buddha, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha. The passage contains an extraordinary sworn guarantee by Mañjuśrī himself: he vows that even one who has committed these most heinous acts will attain results through recitation, staking his own integrity and his relationship to the buddhas on this promise. This rhetorical form is a standard sūtra-style asseveration of the dhāraṇī's power. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage as given.

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## Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.